Help the Care Team See What a Good Day Means for Your Husband

Four prompts to hear what he actually wants, write down the routines that made the day his, work out what joining in would take, and bring it to the people caring for him as requests rather than rules.

Where you are

Your husband moved into care a few weeks ago. The staff are kind and the activity calendar is full, but he spends most afternoons in his room and the mornings don't look anything like the ones you shared. You want the days to feel more like his.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can sit down with his carers and show them, in his words and yours, what an ordinary good day looked like, what he'd like now, and the practical help it would take, while leaving him free to say no.

A one-page Good Day Conversation Sheet: What he's told us, Routines that matter, Activities he'd like and the help it would take, People he wants to stay close to, and How he says no.

Before you start

- Ten minutes with your husband, asking what he misses.
- Your memory of an ordinary weekday before the move.
- The activity calendar and any dietary notes the home has given you. Start with whichever you have.

PROMPT 1

Hear it from him first

WHY THIS MATTERS

Families often answer for the person. He'd love the music group, we're sure of it. Maybe. The quickest way to find out is to ask, and to notice where you've been guessing.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Whatever he said when you asked what he misses, plus your own thoughts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My husband recently moved into a care home. I asked him what he misses and what he'd like his days to include, and here is what he said, mixed in with what I think:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Separate this into two columns: WHAT HE SAID, in his words as closely as I've given them, and WHAT I ASSUME, for anything that came from me. Where something in the second column could be checked by asking him, write a plain, gentle question I could ask next visit. Give me no more than six questions. Don't suggest activities or decide what he'd enjoy.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How much of the picture is yours rather than his.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask him two of the questions on your next visit and add his answers to the first column.

PROMPT 2

Map the day that used to be his

WHY THIS MATTERS

The care conversation tends to be about meals, baths, and the 2 p.m. quiz. The paper with his coffee, the radio at six, the phone call to his brother on Sundays: those are what made a day familiar, and they're the first to go unnoticed.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your memory of a typical weekday and a typical weekend before the move.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what an ordinary day looked like for my husband before he moved into care, as well as I can remember it:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Lay it out as a timeline with five sections: MORNING, MIDDAY, AFTERNOON, EVENING, and NIGHT. Under each, list the routines, small habits, and people that were part of that time of day. Then mark each item in one of three ways: STILL HAPPENS, HAS STOPPED, or WE DON'T KNOW. Finally, list the items you'd expect someone to have in a day that I haven't mentioned at all, such as music, faith, pets, or being outdoors, as things for me to ask him about.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Routines that have quietly stopped without anyone deciding they should.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Pick one stopped routine that could be restored easily and ask the staff about it this week.

PROMPT 3

Work out what joining in would take

WHY THIS MATTERS

The calendar says Bingo, 2 p.m., lounge. For your husband that may mean a reminder at 1:45, his hearing aids in, someone to walk down with him, and a chair near the door. Without that help, the calendar is a list of things happening to other people.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The activity calendar, the activities he's said he'd like, and what you know about getting him from his room to anywhere.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is the activity calendar at my husband's care home, the things he's said he'd like to do, and what I know about what he needs to get somewhere and take part:
>
> [PASTE CALENDAR AND NOTES]
>
> For each activity he has shown interest in, make a row with three columns: THE ACTIVITY AND WHEN, WHAT HELP HE'D NEED TO BE THERE (reminders, walking with him, hearing aids, timing around meals, a particular seat), and WHAT WE DON'T KNOW YET. Don't assume that because something is on the calendar he can reach it. For anything to do with food or drink, list only his preferences; do not interpret or change any dietary instruction the home has given.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The gap between what's offered and what he can actually get to.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask one staff member whether the help in the middle column is something they could offer, or who decides.

PROMPT 4

Write the sheet for the conversation

WHY THIS MATTERS

You're not writing instructions for the staff. You're starting a conversation about what they can offer and what he can choose. The wording matters: Please offer, not He must.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I've put together about what a good day means for my husband:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Write one page with five headings: WHAT HE'S TOLD US; ROUTINES THAT MATTER; ACTIVITIES HE'D LIKE AND THE HELP IT WOULD TAKE; PEOPLE HE WANTS TO STAY CLOSE TO; and HOW HE SAYS NO. Phrase everything as something to offer or ask about, for example “He likes” or “Please offer,” never “He must” or “He should.” Under the last heading, describe only what I've told you about how he declines things. Keep it to requests for discussion, not a plan, and add a line at the end: Things to ask the care team about.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page that sounds like your husband, not like a set of rules.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask for fifteen minutes with the unit manager or key carer and bring the sheet.

His days are one part of his picture

A good day depends on more than the activity calendar. The care interview asks about your husband's health, daily needs, and daily life together and produces a Family Care Profile, so the routines you've written down have the rest of his situation around them.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›